

THE L.V.N.A.

VILLAGER

Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Circulation 1600

July 1995

Held Hostage in Lakewood Village

A Concerned Citizen

On the evening of June 15th, there were numerous police cars and an ambulance parked in my neighborhood. I later learned from Public Safety that the incident was a beating; presumed to be in retaliation for the shooting a few months back at the Little Caesar's near Fremont High School where a young Mountain View gang member was killed. The beating victim on June 15th was a known neighborhood gang member.

Since that Thursday night there appears to be an increase in gang activity as evidenced by neighborhood juveniles sporting their colors. There are two gangs in our area. One wears maroon T-shirts with red Pendleton plaid shirts and carries red bandannas. The other wears similar clothing, except their color is blue. On June 15th and 16th there were two rival gangs roaming our neighborhood looking to settle a score. Anyone could have been their victim, intended or accidental.

No matter how much Public Safety denies the existence of gang activity in Lakewood Village, we do have a gang problem and gang members are living among us. My main concern is that one of these nights one of these gang members may confuse the houses or a ricocheting bullet will wound, maim, or kill an innocent bystander. As made evident by the

continued on page 2

Next L.V.N.A. Meeting

The Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association meets on the second Wednesday of every month. All residents of Lakewood village are encouraged to attend these meetings, to meet your neighbors, learn about upcoming events, and voice your concerns for the neighborhood. Children are welcome.

Date:	Wednesday, July 12th, 1995
Time:	7:00 PM
Location:	Lakewood Park Building at Lakechime and Silverlake
Agenda:	Candidates Vorreiter & Valerio
	Jim Davis, Public Safety Officers Assn.
	Mario Mareno, Neighborhood Resource Off.

Bring a Friend or Neighbor!

From the desk of the President

Craig Crawford, President L.V.N.A.

It's getting time to look at the choices that we have for the City Council seats coming open. At the July 12th L.V.N.A. meeting we will be having two council hopefuls, Pat Vorreiter and Manuel Valerio. In the past we had the new candidates come and talk to the assembly; but we're not going to let them get off so easy this time! I want each member of the L.V.N.A. to have two questions that you would want the candidates answer. Be creative and tough. If these are the people that are to govern our city, we need to screen them well to get the best possible people, ones who will respect Lakewood and be responsive to the unique qualities found here.

We will be having Jim Davis from the Public Safety Officer's Association talk about the safe streets initiative. Mr. Davis' association has a petition that is circulating now. Be informed about this initiative as it will be paid for by your money. Before you sign the petition, come to the meeting and hear the reasons behind it.

Public safety will be updating us about the gang problems that many people feel are a threat. Public Safety has been very responsive to listening to our problems and I feel that they care about us and will be doing what is necessary to help us. Please keep a diary of the calls and case numbers every time you report a problem. This way we will have a better chance of finding out what has transpired in dealing with our problems.

Officers of the L.V.N.A.

President	Craig Crawford	736-7371
1st Vice President	Violette Pavatea	749-9758
2nd Vice President	Patrick Renworth	738-8798
Secretary	Ana Maria Ortega	745-6028
Treasurer	Elena Anderson	745-6028
Newsletter Editor	Geoff Carter	733-0502
Ad Coordinator	Mel Anderson	745-6028

Public Safety Corner

Community Services Bureau

Summer Crime Prevention Tips

Did you know that summer is traditionally a time we experience more criminal activity than usual? Don't let yourself be a summertime victim of crime. Please take the time to follow a few simple precautions while on your trip.

Camping Tips

- ✓ **Auto** - Is your auto parked where it is well lit, can be readily observed, and is patrolled regularly by park staff?
- ✓ **Valuables** - Have you locked your auto and locked your valuables out of sight in the trunk before you reached your campsite?
- ✓ **Camping Gear** - Do you secure your valuable camping gear (stove, lantern, etc.) at night or when you leave during the day?
- ✓ **Emergency Numbers** - Do you have the emergency numbers for the area you are visiting?

On The Road

- ✓ **Cash** - Never carry or display large amounts of cash. Use traveler's checks or charge cards.
- ✓ **Checks, Credit Cards** - Keep traveler's checks, credit card, and telephone numbers handy to report a loss or theft.
- ✓ **Surroundings** - Always be aware of where you are and don't advertise plans, routes, or valuables.
- ✓ **Breakdowns** - Raise the hood, attach a white cloth to the antenna, stay with your car, and ask others to call for help. If you see a stranded motorist, don't stop to help but go to the nearest phone and call for help.
- ✓ **Stalker** - If you feel you're being followed, stop at the nearest service station, market, or anywhere there are people around and call the police. If you feel unsafe to get out of the car, honk your horn and flash your lights and remain locked in the car.

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Dick's Lakewood Center

Held Hostage in Lakewood Village *(continued)*

many "taggings", thefts, vandalism, and violence they bring into the neighborhood, these thugs have no concern for our lives or property.

Sunnyvale Public Safety did saturate the neighborhood the evening of June 15th and 16th. However, there still appears to be a lack of concern from them. When I called that Friday night to report the two groups walking towards each other combatively, the incident was dismissed, no crime committed. Public Safety has been notified of the increasing problem since at least September, yet these juveniles are still roaming the neighborhood, increasingly active in their gang activities.

During the course of these two particular days I became a prisoner in my own house; afraid to leave for the fear of what might happen due to this gang activity. What will it take to make our neighborhood safe again? Why should I, or any one of us, be held prisoner in our own homes when we have not committed a crime? Public Safety needs to respond to these concerns before an innocent child lies dead from the crossfire of gang rivalry, or some fed-up citizen turns vigilante.

Editors Note: Steps have been taken with Sunnyvale Public Safety to address these concerns. *See related articles on the page 4.*

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Community Foundation Awards Grant

Matthew Castrigno

The Community Foundation of Santa Clara County has approved a grant of $3,000 for a collaborative effort between the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association (L.V.N.A.) and the United Citizens of Lakewood Village (UCLV) to provide youth activities. The Committee made this recommendation based on the fact that both groups requested funding to provide positive alternatives for Lakewood Village youth. The grant is conditional upon the attendance of several workshops by representatives from both organizations and the completion of detailed plans and budgets to be submitted by October 1.

What is the UCLV?

Matthew Castrigno

The United Citizens of Lakewood Village (UCLV) is a non-profit California corporation based here in Lakewood Village. It has been organized to raise funds for projects in Lakewood Village that fall within the realm of the charitable and educational purposes for which the UCLV was organized and incorporated. The UCLV is in the business of serving volunteers in the neighborhood who are committed to change and who need assistance from a non-profit group. The UCLV is not another neighborhood association. It is not in conflict or competition with L.V.N.A. but rather we invision the UCLV working partnership with the L.V.N.A. to create a better community here in Lakewood Village.

Some women grow old gracefully. Others resort to stretch pants. *Ginger Rogers*

The Good, the Bad, and the Ugly

Geoff Carter

July 1st was a bright and cheery day; just the kind of day to go out and survey the neighborhood. So, the judging committee took a tour of Lakewood Village to see what we could see. This month the committee was comprised of my wife and me. It sure would be great if someone else was willing to conduct this very unscientific survey and report on the results (hint, hint).

A listing in the Good column is not based upon how much money you have sunk into your home's appearance. So a home that has a neatly trimmed, green lawn, has more of a chance for mention than the one that looks like a showcase for House & Garden magazine. Listing in the Ugly column is earned by not watering or mowing the vegetation in the front yard, letting the paint peel on the house, stacking up trash, garbage, and junk cars, and generally not giving a damn about how your home looks. Unlike Letterman, this is not the top-ten (er top-five) list in either category. The judging is very subjective and the list is in no particular order.

Good	Ugly
821 Lakenoll	1187 Palamos
1142 Stonylake	940 Blazingwood
1162 Charmwood	711 Lotuslake
1240 Oak Creek	295 Meadowlake
1198 Blazingwood	203 Twinlake

Overall, most of the neighborhood looked ok. The most notable "ugly" was yards with dry, unmown weeds/grass. A weekly watering and an occasional once over with a mower would make a world of difference. Take a look and see if you agree. Comments are welcomed at 733-0502.

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A Community's Concerns Addressed

Geoff Carter, Editor

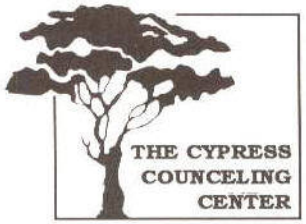
On June 28th, twenty-three of our neighbors met together with Chief Regan Williams, Cdr Don Olson, and Capt Don Johnson at the Lakewood Park building to discuss a serious problem somewhat unique to isolated pockets within our community. The problem discussed was Gangs, Vandalism, and Graffiti.

Our good Chief pretty much tried to pooh-pooh the fears of our residents by reciting city-wide statistics. He also outlined results of the cases generated on one block of one street in our neighborhood. He tried to show crime in Sunnyvale is actually down in most regards, and Lakewood isn't one of the hot spots of activity in the city. I don't think the citizens in attendance were placated in the least.

Of the three representatives from the Department of Public Safety, Cdr Olson was the only one who seemed to listen and brought forth a suggestion for finding a solution to the problems. Granted, I don't think much of the idea, but at least it was something. "What, if anything can we do to turn this neighborhood terrorism around?" we asked. Cdr Olson suggested that we form a committee of about four residents and our Neighborhood Resource Officer to study the problem and come up with recommendations. This smacks of a typical bureaucratic stonewall, study the problem, indeed! We know what the problem is and where they live. But hey, at least Cdr Olson is willing to talk to us and get something started.

When you make a call to Public Safety to report an incident, ask for an "Event Number". Keep a log of your calls and the associated event number, then when we get together with Public Safety, we will be armed with specifics that can be addressed, looked into, and answered. Remember... "Case Numbers" are what go into the statistics that Chief Regan was quoting. They were generated by "Event Numbers" that required further investigation and ended up with prosecution. Not all events become cases. And, from our point of view, the events are the most visible and of most concern to us.

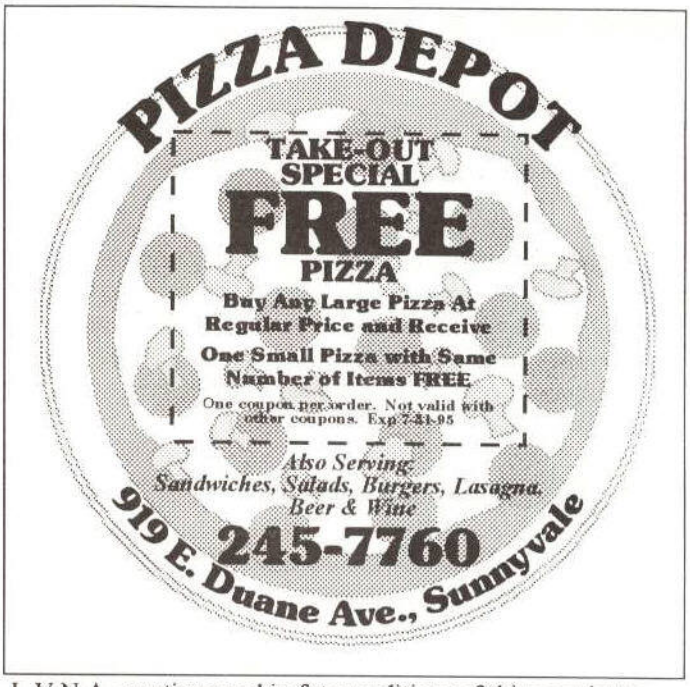
Being the optimistic sort of person that I am, I think that we may eventually get somewhere with this... I do, however reserve the right to modify my opinion as the solution and execution thereof unfolds. Look for follow-up information at L.V.N.A. meetings and in future editions of this newsletter.



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A Letter from Public Safety

Regan Williams, Chief

Since the early 1950's, the Department of Public Safety has been active in the Sunnyvale community by providing law enforcement and fire protection services. This combined approach was designed to avoid duplication of effort, economize staffing without reducing service levels, and allow emergency services to be more flexible and responsive to community safety needs.

The effort by the men and women of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety has resulted in an organization that helps the City of Sunnyvale rank consistently among the top communities with the lowest crime rate statistics for cities with populations over 100,000. The most recent FBI Uniform Crime Reports rank Sunnyvale with the third lowest crime rate for violent crime in the nation. These figures, coupled with a recent survey that ranks Sunnyvale as the best city in California to raise kids, reveals that our city is a very attractive and safe place to live.

The statistics and survey results would mean nothing without concerned and involved citizens, such as those that are involved with the Lakewood Village Neighbors [*sic*] Association. I am proud of the relationship between the Lakewood/Fairwood community and the Department of Public Safety. We can continue to enhance and develop this relationship by maintaining our open lines of communication.

If you have questions, concerns, or comments about your Public Safety Department, please feel free to contact the Community Services Bureau at 730-7140.

Rose colored glasses are never bifocals. Nobody wants to read the fine print in dreams *Ann Landers*

Toothpick of the Month

Craig Crawford

We have a new restaurant in Dick's Plaza, the Sunrise Noodle House. If you haven't been there you are missing the newest food group since pizza. My wife and I have added the Noodle House to our list favorite places to go when she says, "Not tonight, it's too hot to cook."

The prices are very reasonable for the value and size that you get. The soups available are varied. My favorite is the #9 Beef Rice Noodle Soup with rare steak and well-done brisket ($3.95). This is served in a huge bowl with various greens, the meats, and the noodles. The #20 Flat Noodle Seafood Soup with scallops, shrimp, fish, and squid ($4.50) is a seafood lover's delight. Be warned, for the hot and spicy, pain-loving individual that wants to go to the extremes there is #26 Hot and Spicy Beef and Pork Soup with noodles ($4.25). This is an experience that hurts so good.

For the non-soup lovers there are the noodle plates that are also great. My wife likes the #27 Grilled Sliced Pork with rice noodles ($3.95). This is served on a noodle bed topped with greens and nuts. They also have rice plates for the really hungry. I am so glad that this fine Vietnamese food has been added to my diet. If you're tired of the same old Chinese cuisine, then give the Sunrise Noodle House a try.

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Summer Home Maintenance

Virginia Lindstrom

Exterior Painting

Yes, it's the time of year for painting your home's exterior (if it needs it) and here are some tips to help maximize your dollar...

Whether you plan to paint yourself or hire an expert, insist upon a thorough "prepping" of both wood and stucco/masonry as this is the key to years of long lasting results.

Choosing Colors

The overall appearance of our neighborhood is highly impacted by appearances of our individual homes, so do consider this in choosing your home's paint colors. Stay away from "loud", too bright or too dark color combinations.

Feel free to contact me for the latest trends in paint colors, combinations, etc. Also, for references to some painting experts to consult, give me a call. (252-9800)

Happy Painting!

Any woman can be liberated if she wants to be. First, she has to convince her husband.

Martha Mitchell

At the Last L.V.N.A. Meeting

Geoff Carter, Editor

The L.V.N.A. General Assembly meetings continue to be very informative. Over thirty people were in attendance; if you weren't among them, then you missed out.

Vicky Ebstien from the Green Circle Program came and told us about the diversity training they conduct at our schools. Green Circle is a national program that has served our county since 1981, helping our children develop positive social skills through appreciation and respect for human differences.

Landon Noll addressed the assembly regarding the city's budget process. He pointed out that although the city is able to continue most levels of service without increasing taxes, we can't expect this to last very much longer. I'll bet the decision by Lockheed Martin to consolidate some of their satellite building operations in Sunnyvale was most welcome news for the bean counters at city hall.

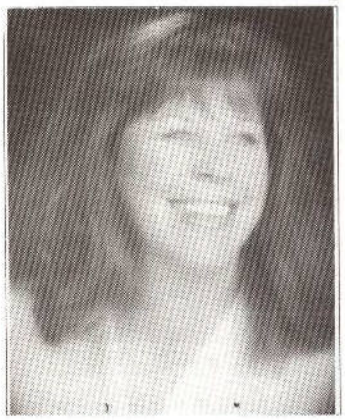
Kalvin Fourtano outlined some of the many programs available for our youth. Look for their monthly newsletter *"Fresh"* at selected locations around the city. I, for one, was surprised there was so many diverse activities out there for our youth. Now if only we could entice them off the street corners and away from their hoodlum buddies and get them to join in the fun.

After the meeting there was a bake sale where donated items were sold at reasonable prices. We are grateful for the donations of Rita Donnough, Lea Crawford, Elena Anderson, Phillis Fowler, and Geraldine Carter. In all, we raise $46.50 that is going directly into the picnic fund for the end of summer neighborhood picnic. This will be a regular feature, so feel free to bring your favorite desert recipe and donate it to the neighborhood. We would also encourage you to bring your sweet tooth and pocketbook to help support this worthy cause.

Editor's Thoughts

Geoff Carter, Editor -- MHO

Ah, you folks are awake after all. My first two newsletters went out to the neighborhood with nary a peep from the readership. Gee, I wondered, was anybody reading this great stuff? I was even contemplating hiding a short little blurb, to be found only by the most diligent reader, requesting a call to see if you had been selected in a random drawing for a lottery ticket. As it turns out, there is no need to resort to such subterfuge. We got lots of calls from our good readers with mostly positive comments about what you read in these pages. Thanks for all the comments & support.



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Newsletter Contributions

Geoff Carter, Editor

If you have a message or concern that would be of interest to our neighbors, please submit your article(s) for the August newsletter no later than July 24th. All submissions will be considered and printed as space allows. For further information, contact Geoff Carter at 733-0502.

Special thanks to this month's contributors: a concerned citizen, Matthew Castrigno, Chief Regan Williams, Virginia Lindstrom, and our noble president, Craig Crawford.

Articles of general interst to the neighborhood are wanted. They will be printed, space providing, with editing only for obvious spelling errors, grammar, (expletives cheerfully deleted) and to fit within the available space.

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